



▷ **MYSQL BR CONF 2026 · SEPTEMBER 26 · SÃO PAULO**

THE STATE OF THE MYSQL ECOSYSTEM

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▷ THE STAKES

MYSQL IS ALIVE. GROWTH NEEDS WORK.

A huge installed base and valuable operational experience

PostgreSQL leads the conversation around new applications

An installed base does not guarantee future adoption

The opportunity: grow the whole MySQL ecosystem

Source: [Stack Overflow 2025 technology survey](#) (developer sentiment, not new deployments)

► DEFINITION

WHAT BELONGS TO THE MYSQL ECOSYSTEM?

- Everything that “speaks MySQL” belongs in the conversation
- Shared connections, tools, skills, and application experience
- Different brands and different capabilities
- Servers are today's focus; the ecosystem is much larger

A shared language

Connects communities without making them the same

Brasil

Portugal

Angola

Moçambique

Cabo Verde

A shared database interface

Connects projects without erasing their identities

Oracle MySQL

MariaDB

Percona Server

TiDB

Vitess

ClickHouse

A MAP OF THE ECOSYSTEM

From shared code at the top to shared interfaces at the bottom

RELATIONSHIP TO MYSQL

EXAMPLES

Upstream server

Oracle MySQL

Forks that track upstream

Percona Server

VillageSQL

AliSQL

Independently evolving fork

MariaDB

Separate distributed implementations

TiDB

OceanBase

Scaling around MySQL

Vitess

Other engines with MySQL interfaces

ClickHouse

MyDuck Server

Doris

StarRocks

Manticore

COMPATIBILITY HAS SEVERAL LAYERS

Layer	What it means for users
1 · Connection protocol	Your driver can connect
2 · SQL and data types	Your statements are accepted
3 · Behavior	Transactions, collations, errors, and results behave as expected
4 · Operations	Replication, backups, monitoring, and upgrades work
5 · Application	Your workload passes functional and performance tests

Connecting successfully is the beginning of compatibility testing.

WHAT WE CAN LEARN FROM POSTGRESQL

HOW POSTGRESQL GROWS

Grassroots advocacy brings in developers

A vendor-neutral brand makes it easier for competitors to invest together

WHAT THAT MEANS FOR MYSQL

MY ASSESSMENT

Oracle's ownership of MySQL changes those commercial incentives

MySQL players can still compete on products and promote the ecosystem together

ORACLE MYSQL: DAMAGE TO TRUST, THEN A CHANGE IN DIRECTION

Staffing losses and community frustration damaged confidence

Oracle has changed its approach to community engagement

Frédéric “lefred” Descamps left Oracle for MariaDB Foundation

The response deserves scrutiny and credit

EARLIER

Staffing losses and community frustration

FEB 16, 2026

Lefred announces his move to MariaDB Foundation

APR 21, 2026

MySQL 9.7.0 LTS widens Community Edition

JULY 2026

MySQL 26.7 credits community contributions



ORACLE

HeatWave

ORACLE CLOUD

MySQL

MySQL

STAY
~~COOL~~
IMPOSSIBLE

40°C

TEMPERATURE

CPU
99%

TEMP
40°C

SELECT ...
FROM ...
WHERE

ORACLE DELIVERED MORE CAPABILITY IN COMMUNITY EDITION



Replication telemetry

Previously Enterprise-only components became available in Community



Hypergraph Optimizer

Became available in Community



JSON Duality Views

Gained Community write support: INSERT, UPDATE, DELETE

The five components: Replication Applier Metrics · Group Replication Flow Control Statistics · Group Replication Resource Manager · Group Replication Primary Election · Telemetry

Concrete changes users can evaluate today

► ORACLE MYSQL · 26.7.0 INNOVATION RELEASE · JULY 2026

MYSQL 26.7 BRINGS THREAD POOL AND NEW INNOVATION TO COMMUNITY



WAS ENTERPRISE-ONLY

Thread Pool

Now in Community: reduces context switching under high concurrency



NEW

Change Stream Applier

Opt-in, per-channel replication applier with up to 1,024 workers



NEW

Post-quantum TLS

Hybrid and pure post-quantum key exchange with OpenSSL 3.5+

Also in 26.7: Group Replication defaults to the MySQL communication stack (was XCOM) · undo truncation progress kept in the tablespace header · innodb_autoinc_preallocate · upgrade-check progress reporting

An Innovation release: evaluate it now, plan production around LTS

Sources: [26.7.0 release notes](#) · [July 2026 GA releases](#) · [First look at 26.7](#) · [26.7 contributions](#)

ORACLE'S COMMUNITY OPENING IS MEASURABLE

43

community contributions in
MySQL 26.7

18

contributors to MySQL 26.7

AWS + Google

representatives participate in
governance

Figures as reported by Oracle. Contributions include different kinds of work, not only code patches.

DELIVERED

**Governance model and steering committee
established**

NEXT MILESTONE

**Full public GitHub development remains a future
milestone (target: end of October 2026)**

PERCONA SERVER: IMPROVING THE FAMILIAR MYSQL PATH

- A MySQL tracking fork focused on mission critical use cases available with open source license
- Percona Server 9.7 release line launched in August
- 8.4.11-11 improves InnoDB buffer-pool and flushing behavior
- Continued investment in performance, diagnostics, and operations

THE WORKLOAD DECIDES

Our published benchmarks show gains in selected I/O-bound cases. Upstream MySQL was faster in the fully buffered cases presented.

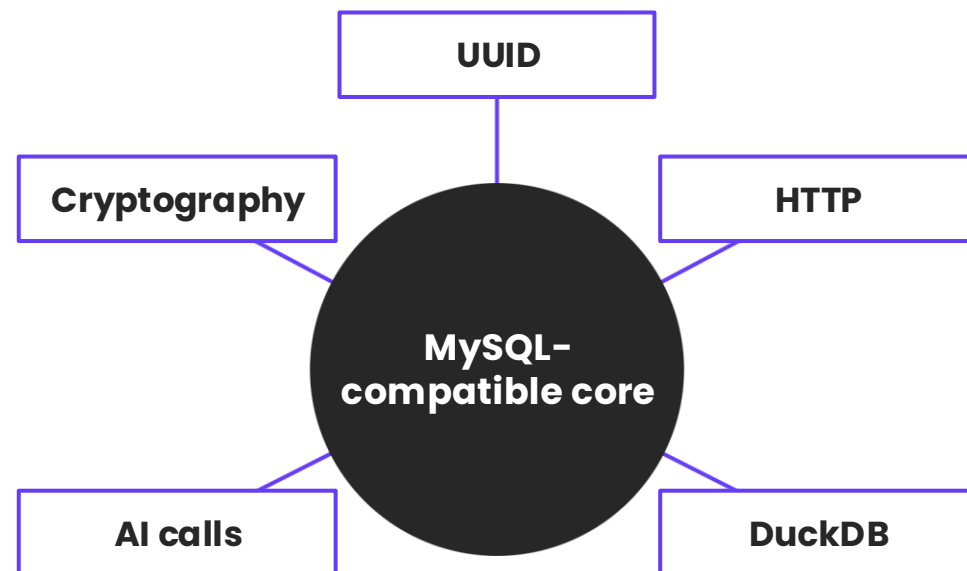
COMPATIBILITY MySQL-based distribution; validate versions, plugins, and operating procedures when changing distributions.

VILLAGESQL: EXTENSIONS AS AN INNOVATION PATH

- Open source tracking fork of MySQL
- Extension framework for custom types and functions
- Examples: UUID, cryptography, HTTP, AI calls, and DuckDB integration
- More developers can add capabilities outside the core release cycle

WHY IT MATTERS

More independent builders can create reasons to choose MySQL.



Custom types and functions, added outside the core release cycle

ALISQL: INNOVATION FROM ALIBABA'S MYSQL BRANCH

Open source MySQL branch maintained by Alibaba Cloud · **AliSQL 8.0.44-2** announced in August 2026

DuckDB analytics

Analytical queries through an embedded DuckDB 1.4.4 engine

Native vector indexing

HNSW-based similarity search for AI use cases

Flashback queries

Read data as it was at an earlier point in time

Transaction & binlog improvements

Some features require explicit configuration

WHY IT MATTERS The engineering community is broader than the vendors most familiar to us.

COMPATIBILITY MySQL 8.0.44-based branch retaining MySQL clients and protocol; added engines and types introduce their own behavior. **Versions based on newer MySQL upstream are NOT released as Open Source**

MARIADB: AN INDEPENDENT DIRECTION WITH SHARED ROOTS

RECENT ECOSYSTEM WIN

Adobe Commerce makes MariaDB its default and recommended database

IDENTITY

Distinct product identity and development direction

CURRENT LTS

MariaDB 12.3 LTS released in 2026

COMMUNITY

Strong community advocacy and a sovereignty narrative

GOVERNANCE

Foundation and Corporation have different responsibilities

WHY IT MATTERS

Application-platform choices can bring whole communities toward MariaDB.

COMPATIBILITY

Shared ancestry and transferable skills; migration compatibility depends on the versions and features used.

PERCONA'S INVESTMENT IN MARIADB

WHY

MariaDB is an important part of the ecosystem's future

Our aim: support demanding production use of open source MariaDB



DONE

Tarus Balog joined Percona as General Manager for MariaDB

PLAN

Our plan: release, maintain, and extend an open source MaxScale fork

STORAGE ENGINES ARE BECOMING INTERESTING AGAIN

Project	What it explores	Status
TidesDB integration for PS MySQL 9.7	An alternative transactional storage foundation	Experimental build
TideSQL for MariaDB	TidesDB through MariaDB's engine interface	In development
DuckDB integration for PS MySQL 9.7	Analytical execution inside a MySQL server build	Experimental build
DuckDB engine in MariaDB 13.0	Columnar DuckDB tables joinable with InnoDB	Gamma; separate package
AliSQL's DuckDB engine	Analytics within Alibaba's branch	Ships in AliSQL



► SCALING

SEVERAL PATHS TO SCALE

Sharding: splitting data across servers

Approach	Main idea	Tradeoff to explain
Conventional MySQL/InnoDB	Replication Based (Standard, Group, Galera)	Write scale and data placement need planning
Vitess	Manage and shard MySQL across servers	Sharding and SQL compatibility require design
MySQL NDB Cluster	Distributed storage engine and high availability	Limited wider-community traction; disk-data constraints; no native AWS/GCP/Azure DBaaS
TiDB / OceanBase	Distribution designed into the database	Network coordination and new operational behavior

NDB community traction is my assessment, not a measured market-share claim.

TIDB: EXPANDING THE WORKLOADS MYSQL USERS CAN SERVE

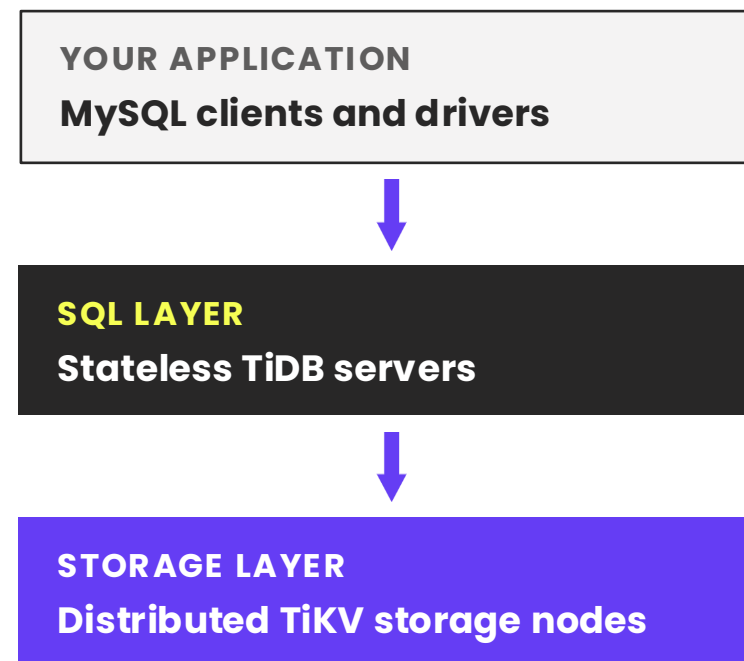
- Independent distributed database developed by PingCAP
- A scaling option for workloads beyond a conventional single server
- MySQL familiarity lowers part of the adoption effort
- 2026 support direction: continued 8.5 LTS and a future supported self-managed path

WHY IT MATTERS

More demanding workloads can retain useful MySQL interfaces and skills.

COMPATIBILITY

High MySQL compatibility claimed; documented SQL, behavior, and replication differences remain.



OCEANBASE: ANOTHER MAJOR DISTRIBUTED MYSQL PATH

- Originated in the Alibaba/Ant ecosystem
- Strong financial-services and large transactional-system heritage
- 2026 update: 4.4.2 LTS emphasizes transactions, analytics, and AI
- Community and commercial offerings
- MySQL compatibility with a different distributed architecture

WHY IT MATTERS

Another independent engineering base broadens the choices available to MySQL users.

2010

Published history begins, in the Alibaba/Ant ecosystem

4.4.2

2026 LTS: transactions, analytics, and AI

COMPATIBILITY Substantial MySQL compatibility documented; inspect the chosen release's matrix. Oracle compatibility belongs to particular offerings and is not a promise about Community Edition.

CLOUD IS A MAJOR PART OF THE MYSQL ECOSYSTEM

Provider	Examples	Distinction
AWS	RDS for MySQL, Aurora MySQL	Managed MySQL and a distinct compatible engine
Google Cloud	Cloud SQL for MySQL	Managed MySQL
Microsoft	Azure Database for MySQL Flexible Server	Managed MySQL
Oracle	MySQL HeatWave	MySQL cloud service with integrated analytics and AI
DigitalOcean	Managed MySQL, MySQL Advanced Edition	Managed MySQL; Advanced Edition adds consensus HA
Alibaba Cloud	ApsaraDB RDS, PolarDB for MySQL	Managed MySQL branch and cloud database architecture
Tencent Cloud	TDSQL-C for MySQL	MySQL-compatible cloud database
Huawei Cloud	TaurusDB	MySQL-compatible cloud database

PERCONA PARTNER

DigitalOcean partnered with Percona (my company) on MySQL Advanced Edition · GA Sept 2026

MYSQL INTERFACES REACH BEYOND TRANSACTIONAL DATABASES

One familiar interface. Many different engines.

Project	Why it belongs in this tour
ClickHouse	Analytical database with a MySQL wire interface
MyDuck Server	DuckDB-powered server with MySQL and PostgreSQL interfaces
Apache Doris	Analytical database using MySQL connections
StarRocks	Analytical engine accessible through MySQL clients
Manticore Search	Search engine with a MySQL-protocol SQL interface

COMPATIBILITY Protocol reuse and selected SQL compatibility; workload and semantics remain product-specific.

PROXIES SIT BETWEEN APPLICATIONS AND MYSQL

Project	Maintainer · license	What it does
ProxySQL	ProxySQL LLC · GPLv3	SQL-aware routing, query rules, multiplexing; MySQL and PostgreSQL
MaxScale	MariaDB plc · BSL, later GPL	Read/write splitting, automatic failover, firewall; MariaDB-focused
Vitess (VTGate)	CNCF · Apache 2.0	Routes queries across shards; the proxy tier of sharded MySQL
Readysset	Readysset Inc. · BSL 1.1	Caches query results, kept fresh from replication; MySQL and Postgres

ALSO OPEN SOURCE

MySQL Router

Oracle; routing for InnoDB Cluster and ReplicaSet; GPLv2

HAProxy

TCP load balancing and health checks; not SQL-aware

Apache ShardingSphere-Proxy

Sharding, read/write splitting, encryption; Apache 2.0

COMMERCIAL AND MANAGED

Tungsten Proxy

Continuent; routing and failover in Tungsten Clustering

Heimdall Proxy

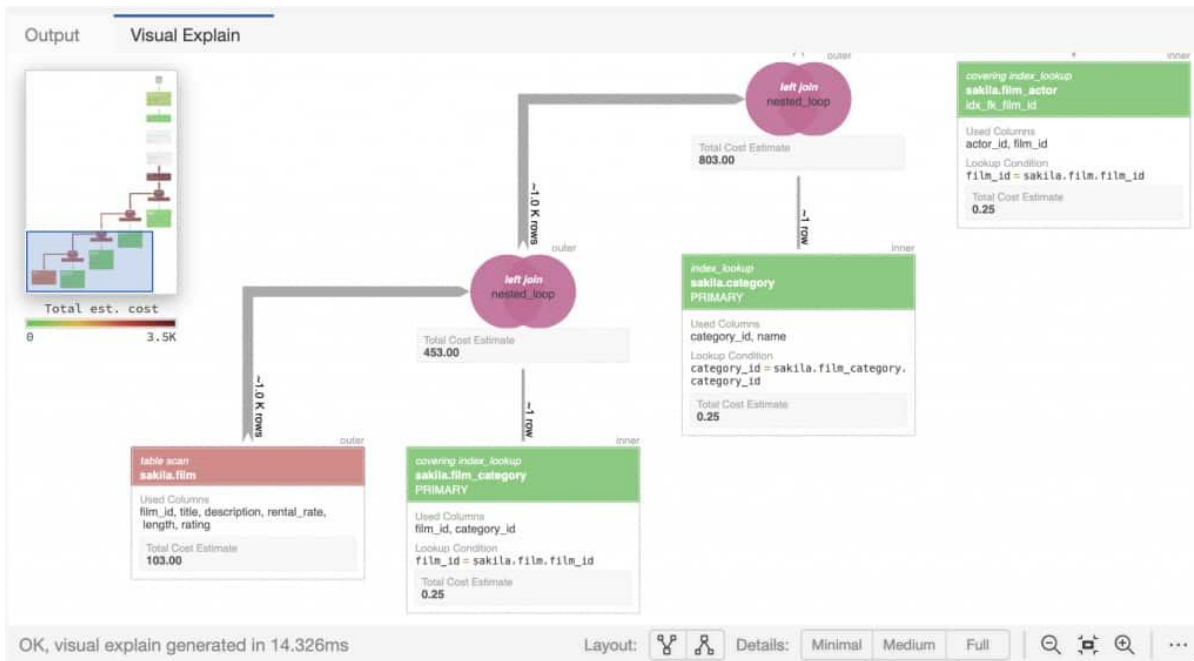
Caching, connection pooling, read/write splitting

Amazon RDS Proxy

Managed connection pooling for RDS and Aurora

► TOOLS

TOOLS ARE GETTING RENEWED ATTENTION



MySQL Workbench 26.7

Arrived in September, rebuilt around MySQL Shell

Orchestrator

ProxySQL maintains an active fork for topology and failover management

dbdeployer

ProxySQL revived and expanded it for repeatable database sandboxes

Everyday tools shape whether developers enjoy using a database

SMALL TOOLS CAN SOLVE PROBLEMS THE BIG PRODUCTS OVERLOOK

DBCanvas

Design and deploy repeatable database labs

By Jaime Sicam

AI-assisted experiments turn practitioners' ideas into usable tools

innodump

Offline data instruction for innodb tables for recovery and investigations

By Przemysław Malkowski

Contribution starts with a problem someone understands

gcache-inspector

Look inside Galera/PXC write-set cache files

By Przemysław Malkowski

Why it matters: useful contributions can come from individual practitioners, not only server vendors



AI RAISES BOTH THE OPPORTUNITY AND THE PACE

DEVELOPMENT

Faster development and maintenance

More people able to build specialized tools

MIGRATION

Easier migration work reduces dependence on installed-base inertia

SECURITY

Faster vulnerability discovery demands faster response

Oracle uses AI in security testing; FuzzySQL reports LLM-assisted fuzzing including MySQL and MariaDB

**AI gives us more ability to improve MySQL and gives users more ability to leave.
We need to earn their choice.**

▶ WORKING TOGETHER

COMPETITION CAN HELP THE WHOLE ECOSYSTEM GROW

Oracle MySQL

Percona Server

MariaDB

VillageSQL

AliSQL

TiDB

OceanBase

Vitess

ClickHouse

Cloud services

Shared users · shared skills · the next generation of developers

EVERYONE

- Try one unfamiliar project
- Contribute one useful finding, fix, or reproducible bug report
- Publish one tutorial in Portuguese and welcome a new developer

VENDORS

- Promote the ecosystem and invest in shared tools, testing, and documentation
- Compete honestly, make compatibility claims testable, and celebrate new users

MYSQL IS ALIVE. ITS FUTURE NEEDS ALL OF US.

Compete on products. Grow the ecosystem together.

Your next step: try a project · share a finding · teach in Portuguese

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